

**START 21
COME, LEARN, RISE!**

CEFR 4 READING

OUR MISSION:

To contribute to improving the quality of education and the standard of living in society by thoroughly teaching foreign languages and sciences.

Preface

Reading is more than just a school subject—it is the gateway to knowledge, imagination, and communication with the wider world. This book, *CEFR 4 READING*, has been carefully designed to make the journey of reading both enjoyable and meaningful for learners.

The selections inside bring together stories, real-life situations, and thought-provoking passages from around the globe. Each unit explores a different theme—travel, nature, traditions, money, science, and more—allowing students not only to practice reading but also to connect with ideas that matter in their lives. Alongside these readings, you will find activities that encourage critical thinking, vocabulary growth, and writing practice. Whether it is composing a simple letter, matching new words with their meanings, or reflecting on a cultural custom, every task is meant to strengthen the link between reading and expression.

This book is guided by one simple belief: reading becomes powerful when it is interactive. That is why learners are invited to question, respond, and share their own experiences while engaging with the texts. The variety of exercises—true/false questions, matching, open-ended writing, and multiple-choice tasks—ensures that different skills are practiced in harmony.

We hope that *CERFR 4 READING* will not only help students develop fluency and comprehension, but also inspire curiosity about the world. May these pages open doors to new ideas, encourage thoughtful reflection, and make reading a lifelong habit full of discovery and joy.

**With respect,
The “Start 21” Learning Center Team**

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“START 21” Code of Conduct

1. General Campus Etiquette

- **Respect and Equality:** Treat everyone equally, regardless of their background or role in the organization. Offensive or disrespectful words or actions will not be tolerated.
- **Environmental Responsibility:** Dispose of waste in designated bins and help keep the campus clean. Report spills or damage promptly to the appropriate staff.
- **Personal Appearance:** Maintain good hygiene, stay neat and tidy, and avoid strong odors that may disturb others.

2. Hallways and Common Areas

- **Keep Moving:** Hallways are for movement; do not block them by gathering in groups.
- **Lower Your Voice:** Keep noise to a minimum, especially near classrooms. If a loud conversation is necessary, step outside.
- **Respect Personal Space:** Do not stand too close to others or block doors.
- **Movement Rules:** Follow posted signs and directions, especially in crowded areas, to ensure smooth and efficient flow.
- **Restroom Use:** Use restrooms properly and maintain cleanliness. Do not dispose of inappropriate items in toilets.

3. Reception Area

- **Purposeful Visits:** Approach the reception with specific questions or concerns. Keep interactions brief and respectful. Loitering or chatting aimlessly in the reception is not allowed.
- **Respect Staff Boundaries:** Reception staff handle process-related inquiries; do not pressure them or demand immediate solutions.

- **Confidential Matters:** Request a private discussion if you need to address confidential information. Do not discuss such matters openly in the reception area.

4. Library and Study Areas

- **Observe Silence:** Always remain quiet. If whispering is necessary, keep it as low as possible.
- **Use Materials Carefully:** Handle books, journals, and other resources with care. Do not fold pages or mark materials.
- **Respect Occupied Spaces:** Do not disturb others' study or work, and do not sit in areas marked "reserved."
- **Device Usage:** Keep laptops, tablets, and other devices on silent mode. Use headphones at low volume if needed.

5. Classrooms

- **Punctuality:** Arrive 4–5 minutes before class and take your seat quietly. If late, enter discreetly and sit in the nearest seat. If another group's lesson is still ongoing, wait patiently until they leave (do not rush in).
- **Respectful Communication:** Raise your hand and wait for your turn to ask questions or make comments.
- **Seating Arrangements:** Follow the seating system if the teacher has assigned one. Do not rearrange furniture without permission.
- **Technology Use:** Use classroom equipment (projectors, computers, smartboards) only as directed by the teacher. Do not touch them without permission.
- **Focus on Lesson Materials:** Participate actively. Avoid using phones, unrelated books, or engaging in side conversations. (Items prohibited under state law must not be brought to class; violators may be held legally accountable.)

6. Dress Code

- **Modest Appearance:** Wear clean, neat clothing appropriate to our cultural values. Avoid overly revealing, short, tight, torn clothing, or garments with offensive graphics or text.

7. Safety and Security

- **Emergency Procedures:** Familiarize yourself with entry and exit routes.
- **Lost and Found:** Report lost items immediately to managers. Do not touch or take items that do not belong to you. Respect others' property. Remember that all areas are under camera surveillance.
- **Electrical Safety:** Follow safety rules when using power outlets. Do not leave devices charging unattended. The administration is not responsible for lost items.

8. Events and Seminars

- **Active Participation:** Take part with openness and respect for other participants.
- **Question Sessions:** Use designated Q&A times and keep your questions relevant to the topic.

9. Feedback and Issues

- **Providing Feedback:** Share your thoughts openly and constructively through official channels (suggestion box, feedback forms, quality control Telegram bot).
- **Reporting Problems:** If you witness or experience inappropriate behavior, report it immediately to the appropriate manager.



Travel and technology

A In the past, people often went to a travel agent to book flights and hotels. Today, technology is changing this. Many travelers now go online, using the internet, to plan their trips, compare prices, and make their own schedules. They also connect with other travelers, read reviews, and find useful information about destinations, local treasures, and possible problems.

B When I plan a trip, I first go to travel-review websites like TripAdvisor. On these sites, travelers share their opinions about hotels, restaurants, and attractions. They give ratings, write reviews, and share tips, such as where to exchange money or which hotel room is best. These reviews feel more trustworthy than advertisements. I also like that I can search by price, location, or quality. When I travel for work, I look for comfort and convenience. But with my family, I try to find the best value and make plans that fit our interests, like food and beaches. **(Geoff, 37)**



C When I was younger, I traveled with my family on package tours. But I didn't enjoy staying in expensive hotels and being separated from local culture. Now, I prefer to travel alone and stay with local people.



I use websites like Couchsurfing and Airbnb to rent a room or stay for free in someone's home. This is usually cheaper and more comfortable. I also get to meet new people and learn about their favorite places, such as cafes, markets, or shops.

By the end of my trip, I often make new friends. **(Hanna, 24)**

D I never travel without my smartphone. I use it to check maps, airports, and much more. Before, I often took taxis or the subway in a new city. This was expensive and didn't help me really see the city.

Now I walk more because I can always use my phone for directions. Even if I make a wrong turn, it will fix the route. I have also used apps to tour museums in New York and London. With the right apps, my smartphone makes traveling easy.



(Rajeev, 28)

E These stories show how technology has changed the way people travel. From online reviews to staying with locals and using smartphones, travelers can now plan trips in a more personal, cheaper, and more interesting way.

A. Write a letter to your friend about your last travel.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	In the past, most people used the internet to book hotels and flights.			
2.	Geoff uses travel websites to compare hotels and read other travelers' reviews.			
3.	Hanna prefers package tours because they are more comfortable.			
4.	Rajeev says his smartphone helps him walk more in new cities.			
5.	The passage says that all travelers like to use Couchsurfing.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|-----------------|-------|--|
| 1. Schedule | _____ | a) Something very valuable or special |
| 2. Rating | _____ | b) A plan of times and activities for a trip or day |
| 3. Attraction | _____ | c) Something interesting or fun for tourists to see or do |
| 4. Convenience | _____ | d) A trip that includes flights, hotels, and meals, usually organized by a company |
| 5. Package tour | _____ | e) something that makes life easier or saves time and effort. |
| 6. Route | _____ | f) The way from one place to another |
| 7. Treasure | _____ | g) A score that shows how good something is |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Why do many travelers prefer online reviews instead of advertisements?
A. Reviews are usually shorter.
B. Reviews feel more trustworthy.
C. Advertisements are too expensive.
D. Advertisements are difficult to understand. | 3. How does Hanna often find new friends during her trips?
A. By staying in local people's
B. By joining package tours
C. By staying in hotels
D. By traveling with her family |
| 2. What does Geoff usually look for when he travels for work?
A. The cheapest prices
B. Beaches and food
C. Comfort and convenience
D. Meeting local people | 4. What does Rajeev say about walking in new cities?
A. He does it less now because it is confusing.
B. He does it more because his phone helps with directions.
C. He only walks when he is traveling with friends.
D. He prefers taxis because they are |

SELLING INDIA'S RAINY SEASON

A In most countries, storm clouds make people unhappy. But in India, when the monsoon rains arrive, millions of people smile. The monsoon season, also called the rainy season, is very important for India's economy. The heavy rains give water to farmland, which provides jobs for millions of workers and food for India's large population.

B The monsoon is usually a happy and important time for farming, but tourism is different. During this season, the number of tourists can become half as usual. Many people do not want to spend their holiday in the rain. Still, the Indian government has tried to change this idea and show that the rains are special. "Watching the rains is one of the best sights I can imagine," says Somini Sengupta, a journalist from Calcutta.

C Some states in India are offering "monsoon packages." Goa, a popular beach area near Mumbai, and Kerala in the south now promote tourism during the rains. They say the season has many benefits,



like cheaper prices and green, beautiful scenery. In Goa, for example, visitors can enjoy islands, waterfalls, lakes, dams, and wildlife parks. Also, many festivals take place at the start or end of the monsoon. In Kerala, the Onam festival in August or September celebrates the harvest with food, dance, music, and boat races. In Puri, the Rath Yatra festival has colorful parades for 21 days.

D India has celebrated the monsoon for a long time, even since the 19th century. Some kings built special "monsoon palaces" to enjoy the rains. The most famous is Sajjan Garh Palace in Udaipur, which sits on a hill and looks over a wildlife park. Today, these palaces show traditional Indian luxury. Modern hotels also try to attract visitors in the rainy season. Some have water parks with pools and slides, others have outdoor discos for dancing in the rain. Luxury hotels even offer private patios where guests can shower in the natural rain.

E Travel writer Alexander Frater spent one whole monsoon season traveling in India. In his book *Chasing the Monsoon*, he explains the energy and traditions of the rains in different places. He saw that many people in western India believe the monsoon brings health and spiritual renewal. One man from Mumbai said it was like cleansing and rebirth. After the storm, the air is cool and full of flower smells. "It is a time of happiness and new life." Many visitors agree. As one promoter from Kerala says, "You can feel the magic. The streets and trees seem to

A. Write a letter to your friend about a rainy day.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	The rainy season in India is important because it provides water for farming.			
2.	Tourism usually increases during the monsoon season in India.			
3.	The Onam festival in Kerala includes food, dancing, music, and boat races.			
4.	Sajjan Garh Palace in Udaipur was built in the 21st century.			
5.	Some people in India believe the monsoon has health and spiritual benefits.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|--------------|-------|--|
| 1. Economy | _____ | a) A person who is traveling for fun or holiday |
| 2. Tourist | _____ | b) Beautiful views of nature, like mountains, rivers, or forests |
| 3. Promote | _____ | c) Connected with the soul, religion, or deep feelings |
| 4. Festival | _____ | d) Something very expensive and comfortable |
| 5. Luxury | _____ | e) A special time with celebrations, music, food, or parades |
| 6. Scenery | _____ | f) To try to make people like or buy something |
| 7. Spiritual | _____ | g) The system of money, jobs, and businesses in a country |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Why do many people in India feel happy when the monsoon arrives?
A. Because schools are closed
B. Because it helps farming and jobs
C. Because it makes traveling easier
D. Because it brings cooler winters | 3. What kind of activities can tourists enjoy in Goa during the monsoon?
A. Camel rides and desert tours
B. Skiing and mountain climbing
C. Islands, waterfalls, and wildlife parks
D. Shopping malls and cinemas |
| 2. What does journalist Somini Sengupta say about the rains?
A. They are dangerous for travelers
B. They are the best sight she can imagine
C. They make people want to leave India
D. They should only be watched from hotels | 4. What do some modern hotels offer to make the rainy season special?
A. Indoor sports competitions
B. Classes about Indian history
C. Free flights to other cities
D. Private patios for showering in the rain |



A No animal species can live on Earth forever. Long ago, species often died out because of natural causes, such as bad weather or other hard conditions. But today, animals are disappearing much faster because of human activity. Until the 18th century, one species disappeared about every four years. In the 19th century, it became one species each year. By 1975, about 1,000 species were lost per year, and today more than 40,000 species disappear every year.

B The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) has made different groups, or categories, to describe how much danger animals face. Animals that are completely gone are called extinct, like dinosaurs and the dodo. If a species only survives in zoos or farms, it is extinct in the wild, like the Wyoming toad.

Animals with very low numbers and in serious danger are critically endangered, such as the Siberian tiger and the snow leopard. Those in high risk, but not immediate, are endangered, such as the giant panda. If numbers are going down but not as quickly, they are vulnerable, like the cheetah and the African elephant. Finally, species with healthy numbers are least concern.



C There are many reasons why animals or plants become endangered. One major reason is the destruction of their habitats — the places where they live. Deforestation and pollution of soil, air, and water are big problems. For example, fewer than 10,000 Sumatran

orangutans now live in Indonesia, mainly because of deforestation and farming. Another cause is humans exploiting animals. In the past, whales were hunted too much, which made many species critically endangered. Elephants are also hunted for their ivory tusks, which are made into jewelry and sold for high prices, even though it is illegal.



D Sometimes, the problem comes from introducing a non-native species into a new place. A native species is one that has lived naturally in an area for a long time. But non-native species are often brought by humans, either on purpose or by accident. For example, the brown tree snake arrived in Guam by cargo ships and killed 10 of the island's 11 bird species. In Florida, pet snakes such as anacondas and pythons have been released into the Everglades swamp. These snakes have grown in number and now compete with the native alligators.



E Organizations such as the World Wildlife Fund and the IUCN work to protect threatened animals and plants. They create programs and work with governments to make new laws that help endangered species. But to really protect nature in the future, ordinary people also need to learn how important it is to keep animals and plants alive. Public education is key to saving species from disappearing.

A. Write a letter to your friend about an animal.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	In the 18th century, about two species disappeared every four years.			
2.	The Wyoming toad only survives in zoos or farms.			
3.	Deforestation is one reason why the number of Sumatran orangutans has decreased.			
4.	The brown tree snake killed all the bird species on Guam.			
5.	Ordinary people do not need to help protect endangered animals.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|------------------|-------|---|
| 1. Extinct | _____ | a) The natural home or environment of an animal or plant |
| 2. Vulnerable | _____ | b) A hard, white material from elephant tusks |
| 3. Habitat | _____ | c) The act of cutting down forests |
| 4. Deforestation | _____ | d) When a species has disappeared completely from Earth |
| 5. Ivory | _____ | e) When a species is in danger because its numbers are going down |
| 6. Non-native | _____ | f) Protecting and saving nature, animals, and plants |
| 7. Conservation | _____ | g) An animal or plant that does not naturally belong in a place |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. What is the main reason species are disappearing faster today?
A. Natural disasters
B. Climate cycles
C. Human activities
D. Lack of food | 3. Why are non-native species a problem for native animals?
A. They destroy cities and villages
B. They compete for food and kill local species
C. They are always bigger and stronger
D. They are more popular with tourists |
| 2. Which category describes animals with very few left and in serious danger?
A. Critically endangered
B. Endangered
C. Vulnerable
D. Extinct in the wild | 4. What role do ordinary people have in protecting species?
A. They need to buy animals from zoos
B. They should join the IUCN
C. They must learn and understand the value of nature
D. They should travel more to wild areas |



A The word ecotourism comes from two words: ecology (the study of living things and their environment) and tourism. The International Ecotourism Society says that ecotourism is "responsible travel to natural areas that protects the environment and helps local people." For example, walking in a rain forest is not really ecotourism unless it supports the local community or protects wildlife. More and more countries are learning that it is possible to make money and also protect nature.

B Costa Rica is one of the leaders in ecotourism. In 2012, it was voted the most popular ecotourism destination by TripAdvisor.com. The country created the Certification for Sustainable Tourism (CST) program in 1999, which later became a model for other countries in Latin America. Today, more than 25% of Costa Rica's land is protected in national parks. Tourism brings in over one billion dollars every year and gives jobs to thousands of people.



C However, sometimes the word "ecotourism" is used in the wrong way. Some businesses use the label only to make money, without caring for the environment. Too many visitors in natural areas can harm the ecosystem. Ecotourists often want to see rare animals and plants, but their presence can put pressure on these fragile species. In some

in Costa Rica, wild monkeys eat garbage left by visitors or even steal food from tourists.

D It is not easy to stop these problems. In developing countries, low salaries and corruption can lead officials to ignore environmental damage. For example, a big resort near a protected area might be allowed if the company pays bribes to government workers. Another problem is a lack of resources. Large areas of forest and beach that need strong protection are often looked after by only a few employees.

E Even with these problems, ecotourism is often better than the alternative. Without it, many natural areas could be destroyed by industries like farming, logging, or mining. Tour guides can teach visitors about the environment and help people respect it. Seeing beautiful rain forests and rare animals makes visitors value nature more and hopefully care for it when they return home. Ecotourism will never be perfect, but with stronger protection, it can help keep nature safe from total destruction.



A. Write a letter to your friend about your garden.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	Ecotourism is travel that helps nature and local people.			
2.	Less than 25% of Costa Rica's land is in national parks.			
3.	Tourists never cause problems for animals in Costa Rica.			
4.	Sometimes resorts are built near protected areas because of bribes.			
5.	The passage says ecotourism was better in the past than today.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|----------------|-------|--|
| 1. Ecology | _____ | a) The plants, animals, and environment that live and work together in one place |
| 2. Community | _____ | b) A group of people living in the same area |
| 3. Destination | _____ | c) When people in power take money or gifts to do something wrong |
| 4. Ecosystem | _____ | d) A place where someone is going to travel |
| 5. Corruption | _____ | e) The science that studies living things and their environment |
| 6. Resources | _____ | f) Things that people use, such as money, workers, or materials |
| 7. Destruction | _____ | g) When something is badly damaged or completely ruined |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

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|---|--|
| 1. What does the word <i>ecotourism</i> combine?
A. Tourism and economy
B. Ecology and tourism
C. Ecosystem and travel
D. Education and tourism | 3. What sometimes happens when businesses wrongly use the word <i>ecotourism</i> ?
A. They harm the environment for money
B. They build more zoos near cities
C. They create new national parks
D. They protect more rare species |
| 2. In 2012, what was Costa Rica voted by TripAdvisor.com?
A. The cheapest holiday country
B. The best place for shopping
C. The safest place for travelers
D. The most popular ecotourism destination | 4. What effect can seeing rain forests and rare animals have on visitors?
A. They want to live in Costa Rica
B. They prefer to visit cities next time
C. They spend more money on hotels
D. They value nature more and care for it |



A When people are asked, "What would you do with a million dollars?" the answers are often the same: "Quit my job," "Buy my dream house," or "Go traveling." Many believe that a million dollars can make all their dreams come true. But today, a million dollars may not be as much as it seems. Twenty years ago, it might have been enough, but now things are different.

B In most developed countries, the cost of things like food, transport, and university fees has gone up. Housing prices have especially increased a lot. This is because the population is growing fast in many areas, but there are not enough homes for everyone. For example, in the U.S., the average price of a new house in 1990 was \$149,800, but in 2010 it was \$272,900. That is why many people see buying property as a good long-term investment.



C Housing in city centers is now more expensive than ever. In the past, people moved from the city center to the suburbs to avoid noise and crowds. But now many people want to live close to work, so demand is very high. Since there is not enough space, prices have gone up. In areas like Mayfair in London or Manhattan in New York, one million dollars is not enough to buy a home. Even countries with lower living

costs, like India or Brazil, have seen big rises in property prices.

D Another reason for the high cost of living is inflation. This means that as prices rise, the value of money goes down. For example,



\$50,000 in 1913 had the same buying power as \$1 million today. Of course, salaries are higher now, but people also spend much more on food, medicine, and housing. Younger generations also save less money. This makes it harder to have enough for the future.

E To live well after retirement, experts say you should start saving early. After you stop working, you will need about 70 to 75 percent of your salary to live each month. For example, if you earn \$3,000 per month now, you will need about \$2,100 to \$2,250 after retirement. This is only possible if you don't have extra costs like paying for a house or children's education. But today, many retired people rent homes because buying is too expensive. Health care also costs more because people live longer, often into their 80s or 90s. For these reasons—a higher cost of living, expensive housing, and longer life—one million dollars may not be enough to retire, travel, and live in your dream home.



A. Write a letter to your friend about your plans for \$1mln.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	Many people think one million dollars can make all their dreams			
2.	Housing prices have gone up because there are too many homes			
3.	In London and New York, one million dollars is not enough to buy a			
4.	In the past, there were too many banks in Western Europe.			
5.	Experts say people will need about 70-75 percent of their salary each month before retirement.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|---------------|-------|--|
| 1. Retirement | _____ | a) Money that you earn from your job every month |
| 2. Investment | _____ | b) Land or buildings that people own |
| 3. Inflation | _____ | c) When prices go up and money loses value |
| 4. Salary | _____ | d) Medical services to keep people healthy |
| 5. Property | _____ | e) The time in life when you stop working |
| 6. Generation | _____ | f) Putting money into something to get more money later |
| 7. Healthcare | _____ | g) People who are about the same age and live in the same period of time |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. What do many people say they would do with a million dollars?
A. Start a farm
B. Quit their job
C. Give it all to charity
D. Pay their university fees | 3. Why are prices in city centers rising?
A. People want to live closer to work
B. People don't like suburbs anymore
C. Cities have too many free houses
D. Cities are becoming less crowded |
| 2. Why do many people think buying a house is a good long-term plan?
A. Housing prices often go up
B. Houses are cheaper in cities
C. Houses never need repairs
D. Banks give free money for houses | 4. Why is health care becoming more expensive?
A. Fewer doctors are working
B. Hospitals are closing everywhere
C. Medicines are free in many countries
D. People live longer |

Lottery winners:

Rich...but happy?



A Every week, millions of dollars are spent on lottery tickets, and many people win big jackpots. Some winners suddenly have much more money than they ever imagined. They can buy a new car, a big house, go on holidays, and even stop working. However, winning the lottery can also bring problems. According to financial expert Steven Goldbart, two out of three winners spend all their money within five years. Because of this, lottery organizers hire counselors to help winners manage their new wealth. Counselors advise them to speak to financial experts and explain how their lives may change.

B Michael Carroll is an example of a winner who lost everything. At 19 years old, while working as a garbage collector in England, he won £10 million. Soon after, he bought a home and turned the backyard into a 24-hour racetrack, which annoyed his neighbors. He also bought expensive cars but was caught driving without insurance or license plates, and he lost his license for six months. Carroll had problems with the law, including drug possession and violent behavior, and he even spent nine months in jail. To continue his lifestyle, he borrowed money, but within eight years he had spent all of his winnings. In 2010, it was reported that he was trying to get his old garbage



collector job back.

C Billy and Jeff Wilson from North Carolina had a very different story. In 2009, they won almost \$88 million. After people learned about their win, they had to move away from their hometown because too many people asked them for money. Billy, the father, stopped working but said the money had not changed who they were. He explained that some rich people are very unhappy and forget that money doesn't make you better than others. His son Jeff continued to live simply, spending time with friends and fishing.



D The Wilsons managed their money carefully, and because of this, they will be able to enjoy their winnings for a long time. Their story shows that being sensible with money can make a big difference. Unlike Carroll, they focused on living a balanced life instead of wasting their money.

E If you ever win the lottery, financial advisors suggest some important rules. First, meet with an accountant or financial expert. Second, pay off all debts, like mortgages, loans, and credit cards. Third, calculate how much you need each year to live and invest the rest. Finally, only quit your job when you are sure you will not need the money from working again.

A. Write a letter to your friend about your lottery victory.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	Two out of three lottery winners spend all their money within five years.			
2.	Michael Carroll was 25 years old when he won the lottery.			
3.	Billy and Jeff Wilson had to leave their town because many people asked them for money.			
4.	The Wilsons started a business secretly after winning the lottery.			
5.	Advisors say you should always quit your job immediately after winning the lottery.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

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|--------------|-------|---|
| 1. Jackpot | _____ | a) A person who gives professional advice or guidance |
| 2. Counselor | _____ | b) The top prize in a lottery or game |
| 3. License | _____ | c) Permission to do something officially, such as drive a car |
| 4. Violent | _____ | d) Owing money that you must pay back |
| 5. Sensible | _____ | e) Using physical force to hurt someone |
| 6. Debt | _____ | f) A person trained to help with problems and give support |
| 7. Advisor | _____ | g) Showing good judgment; making wise decisions |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. Why do lottery organizers hire counselors for winners? | 3. What hobby did Jeff Wilson continue to enjoy after winning the lottery? |
| A. To teach them how to play again | A. Playing football |
| B. To help them manage their new money | B. Traveling abroad |
| C. To stop them from buying cars | C. Driving race cars |
| D. To find them a new job | D. Fishing |
| 2. What did Michael Carroll build in his backyard after winning? | 4. Which of these is one of the rules suggested by financial advisors? |
| A. A swimming pool | A. Pay off all debts |
| B. A small zoo | B. Buy a racetrack |
| C. A racetrack | C. Give money to neighbors |
| D. A football field | D. Stop paying for healthcare |



Wedding CUSTOMS

A Marriage is part of almost every culture in the world, but the traditions are very different from place to place. One important tradition is the wedding dress. In many countries, the bride wears a white dress as a sign of innocence. This tradition began in 1840 when Queen Victoria married in white. Before that, brides wore many different colors, even black, and most women could not afford a dress they would wear only once. Today, dresses are still white but come in many styles and materials. Some brides even have dresses made especially for them. In some Asian and Middle Eastern countries, brides wear red or orange as symbols of happiness. In Asia, it is common for the bride and groom to change clothes several times during the ceremony.

B Another tradition is the exchange of rings. In many cultures, couples give each other rings, usually made of gold or silver, during the wedding ceremony. The circle shape of the ring is a symbol of eternal love. In Brazil, the bride's name is written inside the groom's ring and the groom's name inside the bride's ring. In countries like the United States, England, Canada, and France, the ring is worn on the third finger of the left hand because people once believed this finger had a vein connected directly to the heart. In Hindu tradition, a man gives a woman a bichiya, which is a ring worn on the toe, to show engagement.

C Flowers are also very important in weddings. Roses are seen as flowers of love, and because they bloom in June, this month is very popular for weddings in many countries. Ivy is often used in bouquets as a sign of everlasting love in Greek tradition. Some Middle Eastern brides use Artemisia, a bitter herb, to show that marriage will survive both good and bad times. In Thai weddings, the mothers of the bride and groom place flowers on the couple's shoulders to bring luck and happiness. Couples may also exchange flower garlands to symbolize the beauty of marriage. In many countries, after the ceremony, the bride throws her bouquet into a group of friends, and the woman who catches it is believed to be the next to marry.

D Wedding gifts are another important part of the ceremony. In Chinese culture, guests give money in small red envelopes. Money is also a common gift in Korean and Japanese weddings. In many Western countries, like the United Kingdom, guests usually give the couple household items for their new home. In Russia, however, the couple gives presents to their guests instead. In Scotland, one week before the wedding, the bride's mother may invite people to her home to show all the unwrapped wedding gifts, each with the name of the person who gave it.

E Today, many couples like to mix wedding traditions from different cultures. With so many unique customs, people can choose the ones they like most and create a special celebration for their wedding day.

A. Write a letter to your friend about a wedding custom.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	The tradition of wearing a white wedding dress started with			
2.	In Brazil, couples exchange silver necklaces instead of rings.			
3.	In Thai weddings, mothers of the bride and groom put flowers on the couple's shoulders for good luck.			
4.	In Russia, the couple gives gifts to their guests.			
5.	Wedding traditions are going to disappear in the future.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|--------------|-------|---|
| 1. Bride | _____ | a) A group of flowers carried by the bride at a wedding |
| 2. Groom | _____ | b) A man who is getting married |
| 3. Ceremony | _____ | c) Something that people have done for a long time in a culture |
| 4. Bouquet | _____ | d) Lasting forever, without end |
| 5. Household | _____ | e) A formal event with special actions and words |
| 6. Eternal | _____ | f) A woman who is getting married |
| 7. Tradition | _____ | g) Things used in the home, such as furniture, dishes, or tools |

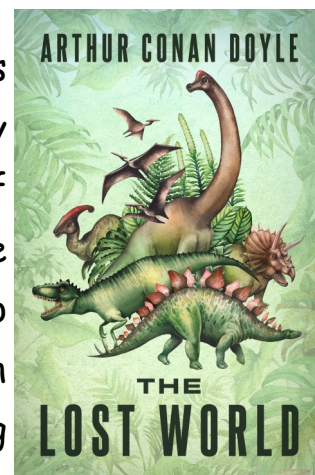
D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. In some Asian and Middle Eastern countries, what colors do brides often wear?
A. White or blue
B. Black or green
C. Red or orange
D. Yellow or pink | 3. Why are roses connected with weddings in many countries?
A. They are flowers of love and bloom in June
B. They are easy to grow everywhere
C. They are cheap and colorful
D. They survive in all kinds of weather |
| 2. In Hindu tradition, what is a <i>bichiya</i> ?
A. A necklace
B. A toe ring
C. A bracelet
D. An earring | 4. In Scotland, what may the bride's mother do one week before the wedding?
A. Show unwrapped wedding gifts at her home
B. Give money in a red envelope
C. Sing traditional wedding songs
D. Prepare a special meal for the couple |

LOST WORLDS OF SOUTH AMERICA

A The world is less mysterious than it was 100 years ago, but there are still places that confuse scientists. Early explorers spoke about strange, high mountains in the jungles of South America. These stories inspired Arthur Conan Doyle to write his novel *The Lost World*, about a land where dinosaurs still lived. The dinosaurs were fiction, but the mountains are real.

B These mountains are called tepuis, which means "house of the gods" in the local Pemon language. They rise thousands of meters above the jungles of Guyana, Brazil, and Venezuela. Tepuis are huge sandstone mountains with flat tops and very steep sides. They are so far away and difficult to reach that scientists have not fully explored them, making them one of the last unknown places on Earth.



C The tops of the tepuis are very old and used to be connected long ago. Some scientists believe they have plants and animals from the ancient continent Gondwana, which existed millions of years ago.



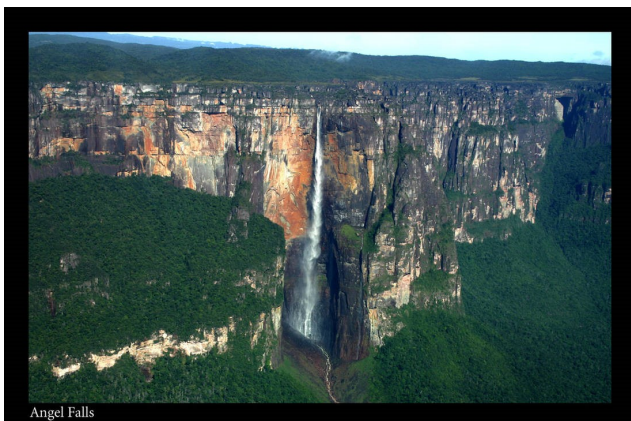
Professor Jesus Rivas says they are like a place where "time stopped," showing how South America's wildlife has changed over the last 300 million years. Because they are so old and high, tepuis are often called

"islands in the sky." Many species live only there and nowhere else in the world.

D One big mystery is how animals and plants reached the tepuis. Some scientists believe they have lived there since the tepuis first formed, but others think they moved up slowly over millions of years. For example, a study of tree frogs found only on tepuis showed that they climbed up little by little. Scientists still do not know for sure and need more research.



E Visiting a tepui is very difficult. Angel Falls in Venezuela, the tallest waterfall in the world, is one of the most famous sights in the region, but it can only be reached



by flying into the jungle and then hiking for hours. The movie Up used the tepuis as inspiration. The filmmakers climbed Mount Roraima, the "easiest" tepui, but it was still a hard six- to seven-hour

climb, followed by more hiking. When they finally reached camp at the top, they were so tired and emotional that some of them cried with happiness.

A. Write a letter to your friend about a fantastic book.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	The dinosaurs in Doyle's book were real, and the mountains were			
2.	Tepuis are easy for scientists to reach and study.			
3.	Some scientists think tepuis have plants and animals from the an-			
4.	Scientists have read about the animals and plants in the book.			
5.	The movie <i>Up</i> was inspired by the tepuis, and the filmmakers climbed Mount Roraima.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|--------------|-------|---|
| 1. Explorer | _____ | a) A large area of land, such as Africa or South America |
| 2. Jungle | _____ | b) A group of living things, like animals or plants, that are the same kind |
| 3. Sandstone | _____ | c) A person who travels to discover new places |
| 4. Species | _____ | d) A forest in a hot, wet area with many plants and animals |
| 5. Continent | _____ | e) A kind of soft rock made from sand |
| 6. Research | _____ | f) The careful study of something to find out more information |
| 7. Waterfall | _____ | g) A place where water falls from a high point, like a cliff or mountain |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. What inspired Arthur Conan Doyle to write <i>The Lost World</i> ? | 3. Why are tepuis sometimes called "islands in the sky"? |
| A. Real dinosaurs found in South America | A. Because they are surrounded by the sea |
| B. Stories from early explorers | B. Because they are high, flat, and separate from the jungle below |
| C. Movies about jungles and adventures | C. Because people live on them like islands |
| D. Research by modern scientists | D. Because they were part of the ocean long ago |
| 2. What does the word <i>tepui</i> mean in the local Pemon language? | 4. How long did it take the filmmakers of <i>Up</i> to climb Mount Roraima? |
| A. House of the gods | A. About one to two hours |
| B. Island in the sky | B. About three to four hours |
| C. Land of the dinosaurs | C. About six to seven hours |
| D. Mountain of sand | D. About ten hours |



Natural mysteries

A Science and technology have solved many mysteries of nature, but some events are still unexplained. Here are three natural mysteries that continue to puzzle scientists: animal migration, raining fish and frogs, and ball lightning.

B For centuries, people have wondered why large groups of animals disappear and return at certain times of the year. Many animals travel long distances to find food, warmer weather, or places to breed. For example, the monarch butterfly flies between 2,000 and 4,500 kilometers from the U.S. and Canada to Mexico, where they hibernate and produce the next



generation. Baby green turtles travel from Ascension Island in the Atlantic Ocean all the way to Brazil, and later return to the same tiny island to lay their eggs. Scientists believe migrating animals may use the sun, moon, stars, magnetic fields, or even smell to find their way—but none of these fully explain how they navigate. Many seem to simply know by instinct.

C In 2012, people in a town in the Philippines were shocked when it started raining fish. Such events have been recorded throughout history and in many parts of the world. The usual explanation is that strong winds pick up small animals, like fish or frogs, and then drop them kilometers away. But in Yoro, Honduras, it has been raining



fish every year for decades. After heavy rain in May or June, small fish are found on the streets, still alive. In the 1970s, National Geographic confirmed that all the fish were the same species but did not live near Yoro. Since 1998, the town has even held an annual "Rain of Fish Festival."

D For hundreds of years, people have reported seeing strange glowing balls of light during thunderstorms. This phenomenon is called ball lightning. The glowing balls, which can be the size of a tennis ball or even a beach ball, move around by spinning, floating, hissing, or bouncing. One scientist, Graham Hubler, remembered seeing it as a teenager: it floated above the ground, entered a building, and then rolled along the floor.



E For a long time, ball lightning had no scientific explanation. But in 2007, two Brazilian scientists created it in a laboratory. They suggested that when lightning hits the ground, it can produce a gas from the silicon in the soil. This gas mixes with oxygen and burns slowly, creating the strange glowing ball of energy. Even so, mysteries like animal migration, raining fish, and ball lightning remind us that nature still has secrets we don't fully understand.

A. Write a letter to your friend about a snowy day.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	Scientists have completely explained all natural mysteries.			
2.	Monarch butterflies fly thousands of kilometers from the U.S.			
3.	In Yoro, Honduras, people don't buy fish because of the rain.			
4.	Ball lightning can be as small as a tennis ball or as big as a football.			
5.	Two Brazilian scientists created ball lightning in a laboratory in 2007.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|------------------|-------|---|
| 1. Migration | _____ | a) A group of animals or plants that are the same kind |
| 2. Hibernate | _____ | b) To sleep through the winter |
| 3. Phenomenon | _____ | c) A special event or celebration, often with food and music |
| 4. Species | _____ | d) The movement of animals from one place to another at certain times of the year |
| 5. Thunderstorms | _____ | e) A natural event or fact that people can see or notice |
| 6. Festival | _____ | f) A place where scientists do experiments and research |
| 7. Laboratory | _____ | g) Storms with lightning, thunder, heavy rain, and sometimes wind |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Which three mysteries are described in the passage? | 3. Since when has Yoro, Honduras, had a "Rain of Fish Festival"? |
| A. Earthquakes, volcanoes, and storms | A. 1970s |
| B. Migration, raining fish, and ball lightning | B. 1980 |
| C. Tornadoes, floods, and forest fires | C. 1998 |
| D. Snowstorms, earthquakes, and raining frogs | D. 2012 |
| 2. Which animals return to the same island to lay their eggs? | 4. What gas do scientists believe mixes with oxygen to create ball lightning? |
| A. Green turtles | A. Carbon |
| B. Monarch butterflies | B. Silicon |
| C. Frogs | C. Nitrogen |
| D. Fish | D. Hydrogen |



A Hi everyone,

I have a question for all the experienced dieters out there: What is the best way to lose weight and keep it off? I've tried many fad diets—low fat, low carb, grapefruit, cabbage soup—you name it! I always lose some weight but can never keep it off. Also, eating the same food every day is really boring! How do you manage it?

JudyGirl, Spokane, Washington

B Fad diets didn't work for me either. The problem is that you eat too much of one food and get tired of it, or you don't get enough of



the food your body needs. Then when you stop the diet, you eat too much of the foods you missed, and the weight comes back. My solution has been portion control. I watch serving sizes and eat everything in small amounts. For example, at dinner, I eat one piece of meat, some rice, and a salad. I eat slowly, no second helpings, and no snacks between meals! This way, I eat less but enjoy it more. It has really worked for me.

Drew T., Chicago

C My method is "no white foods." That means no white bread, pasta, potatoes, or desserts with white flour and sugar. These foods are high in calories but low in nutrition. Instead, I eat whole grain foods like whole wheat bread, crackers, and oatmeal. These are healthier and fill you up because they have more fiber. So, think brown foods, not white!

QueenMother, London

D Food is only part of the problem. I always ate fairly well, but I never exercised. Then I joined a weight-loss clinic, and a counselor told me to start working out. I joined a gym and began lifting weights, swimming, and jogging. Exercise changed my life. I lost 10 kilograms without changing my diet much (except for eating fewer desserts). I've kept the weight off for three years. You don't need to do too much—just a few sessions a week can be enough.

JimGym, Sydney

E I used to eat a lot of meat, junk food, and fast-food hamburgers. I wasn't very overweight, but I felt tired all the time. Then I tried a vegetarian diet. I didn't lose weight quickly, but I lost a little every month. More importantly, I feel healthier and have more energy now. It can be difficult because not all restaurants have vegetarian meals, and you must plan carefully. But for me, it's worth it—I look better and feel great!

Minjoo, San Francisco

A. Write a letter to your friend about your favorite meal.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	JudyGirl says she can lose weight on fad diets, but she always			
2.	Drew T. eats large amounts of meat and snacks between meals.			
3.	QueenMother avoids white bread, pasta, and sugar because they are high in calories but low in nutrition.			
4.	JimGym lost 10 kilograms mainly because he started exercising.			
5.	Minjoo says she has already tried 3 types of fad diet.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|---------------|-------|--|
| 1. Portion | _____ | a) A small amount of food you eat at one time |
| 2. Fiber | _____ | b) A person trained to give advice and support |
| 3. Counselor | _____ | c) Substances in food that help the body stay healthy |
| 4. Vegetarian | _____ | d) A medical center where people get help with health problems |
| 5. Nutrition | _____ | e) A person who does not eat meat or fish |
| 6. Clinic | _____ | f) Part of food (from plants) that helps digestion and makes you feel full |
| 7. Serving | _____ | g) The size or amount of food given to one person |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. What problem does JudyGirl mention about fad diets?
A. They are too expensive
B. They are boring
C. They make her feel very sick
D. They give too much energy | 3. What kind of foods does QueenMother prefer to eat?
A. Fried foods
B. Junk foods
C. Whole grain foods
D. Fast foods |
| 2. What example of portion control does Drew T. give for dinner?
A. A sandwich, soup, and fruit
B. A piece of meat, rice, and a salad
C. Pasta, bread, and dessert
D. Two servings of meat and potatoes | 4. What difficulty does Minjoo mention about being vegetarian?
A. Some restaurants don't have vegetarian meals
B. She feels hungry all the time
C. Her family doesn't support her choice
D. Vegetarian food is always very expensive |

BAREFOOT

RUNNING

A In recent years, barefoot running has become popular. This means running with very light sandals or with no shoes at all. Many athletes say running barefoot helped them avoid or cure injuries, or even improved their running style and race times. Others, however, argue there is no medical proof that barefoot running is safer or better than wearing traditional running shoes.

B Experts note that some of the best long-distance running cultures, like the Tarahumara Indians of Mexico and the Marathon Monks



of Japan, often run barefoot or in thin sandals. These groups rarely suffer leg injuries. Injuries that are common among people who wear shoes, like knee and back



pain, are not often seen in barefoot runners. Supporters of barefoot running believe it makes foot and calf muscles stronger, improves balance, reduces shock when landing, and can even make runners faster.

C Researchers have observed that barefoot runners usually land on the front part of the foot, called the forefoot or ball, instead of the heel. This means only a small part of the foot stops suddenly when it touches the ground. The natural spring-like movement of the foot

and leg then absorbs the shock. By contrast, most runners in shoes land on their heels, which puts more stress on the joints and back.

D A 2012 study compared runners with shoes to those without. It found that barefoot runners used six percent less energy. Because they take shorter steps and have different ground contact, they need

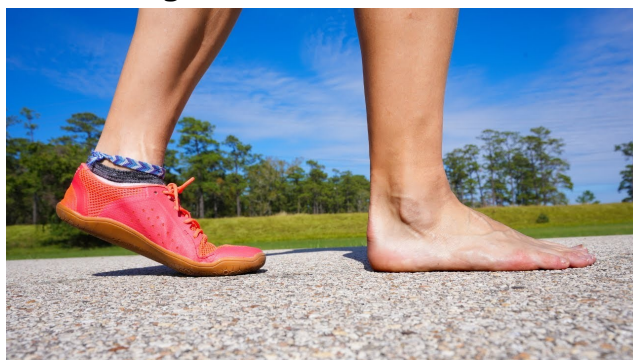


less oxygen and feel less tired. According to the study, this energy saving is about the same as six weeks of training in shoes. Still, there is no final answer, and the debate about barefoot running continues. Doctors warn that people who

usually run in shoes should not switch too quickly.

E For those who want to try barefoot running, doctors and coaches give several tips. Start slowly, first walking short distances without shoes so your feet can get used to

it. Listen to your body—if your feet or muscles hurt, rest before trying again. Stretch and massage your legs and feet to keep muscles flexible and strong. Finally, pay at-



tention to your landing. It should feel soft, almost like bouncing. If it feels too hard, slow down and focus on a gentle landing.

A. Write a letter to your friend about your favorite sport.

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

No	Sentences	T	F	N.G
1.	Some athletes believe barefoot running improves their perfor-			
2.	The Tarahumara Indians of Mexico often suffer from knee and back pain.			
3.	Barefoot runners don't usually wear shoes at all in China.			
4.	A study showed barefoot runners used more oxygen than runners in shoes.			
5.	Doctors say beginners should start barefoot running slowly and carefully.			

C. Match the words with their definitions

- | | | |
|-------------|-------|--|
| 1. Athlete | _____ | a) The ability to stay steady and not fall |
| 2. Injury | _____ | b) A person who trains and competes in sports |
| 3. Balance | _____ | c) Damage or harm to the body |
| 4. Joint | _____ | d) The part of the leg between the knee and the ankle, at the back |
| 5. Calf | _____ | e) Able to bend or move easily without breaking |
| 6. Energy | _____ | f) A place in the body where two bones meet |
| 7. Flexible | _____ | g) The strength or power needed to do something |

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. What do some people argue about barefoot running?
A. It is always safer than wearing shoes
B. There is no medical proof it is better
C. It helps every athlete run faster
D. It prevents all types of injuries | 3. What happens when runners land on their heels?
A. The foot absorbs the shock naturally
B. It puts more stress on the and back
C. They use less oxygen
D. They feel like bouncing |
| 2. What do supporters of barefoot running believe it can do?
A. Make the feet and calves stronger
B. Stop people from getting hungry
C. Help people sleep better
D. Cure headaches | 4. According to doctors, how should a runner's landing feel?
A. Very hard
B. Like jumping on rocks
C. Soft, like bouncing
D. Heavy and strong |

ANSWERS

Travel and technology

A. Write a letter to your friend about your last travel. (Possible answers)

Dear Anna,

How are you? I want to tell you about my last trip. I went to Rome with my family last month. The city was beautiful, and the weather was sunny. We visited the Colosseum, the Vatican, and many old streets. I took a lot of photos and ate delicious pizza and pasta.

It was a wonderful experience. I hope we can travel together one day!

Best wishes,
Maria

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	False	4.	True
2.	True	5.	Not given
3.	False		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	B	5.	D
2.	G	6.	F
3.	C	7.	A
4.	E		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	A
2.	C	4.	B

Selling India's rainy season

A. Write a letter to your friend about a rainy day. (Possible answers)

Dear Mark,

How are you? I want to tell you about a rainy day last month. It rained all day, and the streets were wet and noisy with cars. I stayed at home because I didn't want to get wet.

In the morning, I watched a movie and drank hot tea. Later, I read a book and listened to music. The sound of the rain on the window was very relaxing. In the evening, the rain stopped, and the air was cool and fresh.

It was a quiet day, but I enjoyed it. Do you like rainy days? Please write and tell me.

Best wishes,
Alex

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	Not given
2.	False	5.	True
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	G	5.	D
2.	A	6.	B
3.	F	7.	C
4.	E		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	C
2.	B	4.	D

Endangered species

A. Write a letter to your friend about an animal. (Possible answers)

Dear Emma,

How are you? I want to tell you about an animal I like very much — the elephant. Last weekend, I visited a wildlife park with my family, and I saw some elephants there. They were very big, with long trunks and large ears. I was surprised at how gentle they looked, even though they are so strong.

The guide told us that elephants are very intelligent and can remember places and people for many years. I also learned that they live in family groups and take care of each other. My favorite part was watching a baby elephant playing with water. It was so cute and funny!

Seeing elephants made me think about how important it is to protect animals. I really enjoyed the trip, and I hope to see them again one day. Do you have a favorite animal? Please write and tell me.

Best wishes,

Sophie

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	Not given	4.	False
2.	True	5.	False
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	D	5.	B
2.	E	6.	G
3.	A	7.	F
4.	C		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	C	3.	B
2.	A	4.	C

Ecotourism

A. Write a letter to your friend about your garden. (Possible answers)

Dear Lily,

How are you? I want to tell you about my garden. It is behind my house, and I spend a lot of time there, especially in the mornings. The garden is not very big, but it is full of flowers, plants, and even some vegetables. In one corner, I have roses and sunflowers. They look so colorful when the sun shines. I also grow tomatoes, cucumbers, and carrots. My father and I water the plants every evening, and it feels relaxing after a long day. There are also a few trees that give shade, so I can sit under them and read a book.

Last week, I planted some herbs like mint and basil. They smell wonderful, and my mother uses them for cooking. I feel proud when we eat something that grows in our own garden.

Do you have a garden too? Please write back and tell me about it.

Best wishes,

Sofia

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	True
2.	False	5.	Not given
3.	False		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	E	5.	C
2.	B	6.	F
3.	D	7.	G
4.	A		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	A
2.	D	4.	D

\$1 million challenge

A. Write a letter to your friend about your plans for \$1mln. (Possible answers)

Dear Tom,

How are you? I want to tell you about my plans if I had one million dollars. It is such a big amount of money, and I have many ideas. First, I would buy a comfortable house for my family. It would have a garden, and maybe even a swimming pool. Then, I would travel around the world. I want to see famous places like the Eiffel Tower in Paris and the Great Wall of China. I would also save some money for the future, and I would give part of it to charity to help poor children. Finally, I would like to start my own small business, maybe a café or a bookstore. What about you? What would you do with one million dollars? Please write back and tell me your ideas.

Best wishes,

Alex

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	Not given
2.	False	5.	False
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	E	5.	B
2.	F	6.	G
3.	C	7.	D
4.	A		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	A
2.	A	4.	D

Lottery winners: rich...but happy?

A. Write a letter to your friend about your lottery victory . (Possible answers)

Dear Sarah,

I have amazing news! Last week, I bought a lottery ticket just for fun, and I actually won. I couldn't believe it when I saw the numbers on TV — they all matched my ticket. I felt shocked and very excited at the same time. With this money, I plan to do many things. First, I will help my family by buying a nice house for us. I also want to travel around the world, because it has always been my dream to see new countries. Of course, I will save some money for the future, and I would like to give part of it to charity to help people in need. Winning the lottery has changed my life, and I feel very lucky. I hope you can come and celebrate with me soon.

Best wishes,

Alex

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	Not given
2.	False	5.	False
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	B	5.	G
2.	F	6.	D
3.	C	7.	A
4.	E		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	D
2.	C	4.	A

Wedding customs

A. Write a letter to your friend about a wedding custom. (Possible answers)

Dear Emma,

How are you? I want to tell you about a wedding custom in Uzbekistan. Weddings here are very big and important events. Families often invite hundreds of guests, sometimes even more than a thousand! One special custom is called *kelin salom*. It happens when the bride greets the guests for the first time in her new family. She makes a traditional bow, and people give her small gifts or money. It is a way of showing respect and welcoming her into the family. Another important part of the wedding is the food. The families prepare *plov*, a famous Uzbek rice dish with meat and carrots. It is always served at weddings, and everyone enjoys it together. There is also music, dancing, and many traditional songs. Uzbek weddings are full of joy, and they usually last for a whole day, sometimes even longer. I think you would enjoy seeing one! Do you have special wedding customs in your country? Please write and tell me.

Best wishes,

Dilshod

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	True
2.	False	5.	Not given
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	F	5.	G
2.	B	6.	D
3.	E	7.	C
4.	A		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	C	3.	A
2.	B	4.	A

The lost world of South America

A. Write a letter to your friend about a fantastic book . (Possible answers)

Dear Anna,

How are you? I want to tell you about a fantastic book I have just finished reading. It is called *The Alchemist* by Paulo Coelho. The story is about a young shepherd named Santiago who travels across deserts to follow his dream of finding treasure. On his journey, he meets many people who teach him about life, hope, and following your heart. What I liked most about the book is its message: if you really want something, and you work for it, life will help you reach it. The language is simple but very beautiful, and it made me think about my own dreams. I enjoyed this book so much that I want to read it again! I think you would love it too, because it is full of adventure and wisdom. Have you read any good books recently? Please write and tell me.

Best wishes,

Sofia

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	False	4.	Not given
2.	False	5.	True
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	C	5.	A
2.	D	6.	F
3.	E	7.	G
4.	B		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	B
2.	A	4.	C

Natural mysteries

A. Write a letter to your friend about a snowy day . (Possible answers)

Dear Emily,

How are you? I want to tell you about a snowy day we had last week. When I woke up in the morning, everything outside was white. The trees, the cars, and even the streets were covered with snow. It looked like a beautiful winter postcard. School was canceled, so I stayed at home. My brother and I went outside to play. We built a snowman, threw snowballs at each other, and then went sledding down a small hill near our house. It was so much fun, but also very cold!

In the afternoon, we went back inside, made hot chocolate, and sat by the window watching the snow continue to fall. The whole day felt peaceful and magical.

Do you get snowy days where you live? I would love to hear about it.

Best wishes,

Sofia

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	False	4.	False
2.	True	5.	True
3.	Not given		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	D	5.	G
2.	B	6.	C
3.	E	7.	F
4.	A		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	C
2.	A	4.	B

Successful dieting

A. Write a letter to your friend about your favorite meal. (Possible answers)

Dear Maria,

How are you? I want to tell you about my favorite meal. It is plov, a traditional rice dish from Uzbekistan. I love it because it is delicious, healthy, and it always reminds me of family gatherings. Plov is made with rice, carrots, onions, and pieces of meat, usually lamb or beef. It is cooked slowly in a big pot, and the smell is amazing. Sometimes raisins or chickpeas are added to make it even tastier. My mother makes the best plov, and everyone in the family enjoys it together. I usually eat plov on weekends or during special celebrations. It is not only food but also a way to bring people together. Eating it always makes me feel happy and proud of our tradition.

What is your favorite meal? Please write back and tell me about it.

Best wishes,

Dilshod

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	True
2.	False	5.	Not given
3.	True		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	G	5.	C
2.	F	6.	D
3.	B	7.	A
4.	E		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	C
2.	B	4.	A

Barefoot running

A. Write a letter to your friend about your favorite sport. (*Possible answers*)

Dear Alex,

How are you? I want to tell you about my favorite sport. It is football, and I enjoy it very much. I usually play it twice a week with my friends at the local stadium.

I like football because it is fast, exciting, and it helps me stay healthy. My favorite position is forward because I love trying to score goals. Sometimes I watch professional matches on TV, and I learn new tricks from famous players. My favorite team is Barcelona, and I never miss their games.

Football is also a great way to spend time with friends. Even when we lose, we laugh and have fun together. I always feel happy and full of energy after a good match.

What about you? Do you have a favorite sport? Please write back and tell me.

Best wishes,

Sam

B. Read the sentences below. Decide if they are True, False, or Not Given according to the text.

1.	True	4.	False
2.	False	5.	True
3.	Not given		

C. Match the words with their definitions

1.	B	5.	D
2.	C	6.	G
3.	A	7.	E
4.	F		

D. Choose the correct option: A, B, C or D.

1.	B	3.	B
2.	A	4.	C